PRINTABLE KIT · ONE PDF · DIWALI 2026

Lakshmi Puja at home, away from India

A household vidhi, traditional mantras in Devanagari with a transliteration and an English meaning, a checklist, the days of Diwali 2026, a page to read with children, and six cards.

Dhanteras is Friday 6 November 2026 on every Drik Panchang city page checked for this kit. Lakshmi Puja is Sunday 8 November 2026 in those cities. Bhai Dooj is Wednesday 11 November 2026 in New Delhi, and a day earlier in some countries. The timeline says which.

This is a home sequence, not a priest's manual and not the only way. If your family has a vidhi, use that. Confirm the muhurat with your local temple before you start.

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How to use this file

1. Read the timeline and circle your city's column for Govardhan Puja and Bhai Dooj.
2. Print the checklist and shop once.
3. On Sunday 8 November, use your city's muhurat. The table is the line Drik Panchang calls "Lakshmi Puja Muhurat".
4. Say the mantras you know. The English is there so a child, or you, can follow the sense.
5. Print the cards single-sided if you can, and cut on the border.

Times were copied from Drik Panchang on 27 October 2026. They were not calculated from another city. Confirm them with your temple. A later edit on Drik's site, or a temple custom, can change the window you keep.

In a rented flat: skip camphor and incense if a smoke alarm will go off. One lamp is enough. Put every flame out before you sleep or leave the room. Tell the people you live with.

The days of Diwali 2026

Families often count five days: Dhanteras, the eve (Chhoti Diwali), Lakshmi Puja, Govardhan Puja, and Bhai Dooj. In 2026 they are not five consecutive dates everywhere, and two of the names share a morning and an evening in India.

1. Dhanteras

Friday 6 November 2026. Checked on Drik Panchang for New Delhi and for all 13 cities in the muhurat table. Many families buy something metal, even a spoon, and light a lamp in the evening.

2. The eve

On the New Delhi Diwali calendar, Drik lists Kali Chaudas on Saturday 7 November 2026, and Narak Chaturdashi (the oil bath, Tamil Deepavali) on the morning of Sunday 8 November 2026. Separate city pages for those two names were not copied into this kit. Ask your temple which morning they are keeping.

3. Lakshmi Puja

Sunday 8 November 2026 in every city below. This is the main evening puja.

4 and 5. Govardhan Puja and Bhai Dooj

These two shift together. On the Drik city pages read for this kit:

CITIES	GOVARDHAN PUJA	BHAI DOOJ
New York, San Francisco, Chicago, Houston, Toronto, Vancouver, London, Leicester, Dubai	Monday 9 November 2026	Tuesday 10 November 2026
Sydney, Melbourne, Auckland, Singapore, and New Delhi	Tuesday 10 November 2026	Wednesday 11 November 2026

New Delhi day names: drikpanchang.com/diwali/diwali-puja-calendar.html. City dates: the Dhanteras, Govardhan Puja, and Bhai Dooj pages on drikpanchang.com with the same geoname-id as the Lakshmi table. Lakshmi Puja muhurat source: drikpanchang.com/festivals/lakshmipuja/festivals-lakshmipuja-timings.html?geoname-id=…

Lakshmi Puja muhurat, local time

Sunday 8 November 2026. This is Drik's labeled muhurat: Vrishabha inside Pradosh Kaal. On the Sydney, Melbourne, Auckland, and Singapore pages, Vrishabha continues after Pradosh, and the labeled muhurat stops when Pradosh stops.

CITY	MUHURAT	GEONAME-ID
New York City	05:04 PM to 06:52 PM	5128581
San Francisco	05:24 PM to 07:15 PM	5391959
Chicago	04:55 PM to 06:43 PM	4887398
Houston	05:52 PM to 07:47 PM	4699066
Toronto	05:17 PM to 07:03 PM	6167865
Vancouver	05:55 PM to 07:36 PM	6173331
London	04:35 PM to 06:12 PM	2643743
Leicester	04:34 PM to 06:10 PM	2644668
Sydney	08:04 PM to 09:33 PM	2147714

CITY	MUHURAT	GEONAME-ID
Melbourne	08:37 PM to 10:03 PM	2158177
Auckland	08:36 PM to 10:02 PM	2193733
Singapore	07:19 PM to 09:13 PM	1880252
Dubai	05:58 PM to 07:56 PM	292223

Household vidhi

Do this during the muhurat if you can. If you miss the window, do it the same evening while you are still awake. A late sincere puja is the advice this kit will give. Your temple may say otherwise, and you should follow the temple.

1. **Place.** Clean a corner. Spread a cloth. Set a picture of Lakshmi, and Ganesha if you have one. East is usual. Another wall is acceptable.
2. **Kalash.** Fill a jug with water. Add a coin. A few clean leaves at the mouth are traditional and optional.
3. **Offerings on a plate.** Raw rice, turmeric or kumkum, flowers, a fruit, a sweet. A notebook if your family does the account-book puja.
4. **Lamp.** Light ghee or oil. No flame allowed: switch a lamp on instead.
5. **Sankalp.** Say your name, the city, and "I am doing Lakshmi Puja on Diwali." Your language is fine. A Sanskrit sankalp is not required for this home order.
6. **Ganesha first.** Bow, and say the short Ganesha mantra or the Vakratunda verse.
7. **Lakshmi.** Offer water onto a small dish, then rice, a flower, and the sweet. Recite the seed mantra and as much of the Shri Sukta opening as you want. Read the English if the Sanskrit is new.
8. **Lamp verse.** Say the deepa shloka once when the lamp is lit, or at the start of aarti.
9. **Door.** If it is safe, put a second lamp by the door. If it is not, stay with the one lamp.
10. **Aarti.** Circle a plate with the lamp clockwise, slowly, a few times. Sing the opening of the Lakshmi aarti, or sit quietly through one minute.
11. **Close.** Bow. Share the sweet. Leave the pictures as they are overnight if that is your custom, and extinguish anything that can burn unattended.

Pronounce the mantras as well as you can. A missed vowel does not spoil a household puja. If you have a family recording, follow that instead of this page.

Mantras

These are traditional texts used in household worship. The Shri Sukta verses are the opening of the hymn in the Rigveda khila. The English under each verse is a plain meaning written for this kit. It is not a quotation from a copyrighted translation. Wording of the Gayatri and the aarti varies by family. Use the form your priest gave you if it differs.

Ganesha, short

ॐ गणेशाय नमः

Om Ganeshaya namah.

Salutation to Ganesha.

Vakratunda

वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय सूर्यकोटि समप्रभ ।
निर्विघ्नं कुरु मे देव सर्वकार्येषु सर्वदा ॥

Vakratunda mahakaya suryakoti samaprabha.
Nirvighnam kuru me deva sarvakaryeshu sarvada.

You of the curved trunk and great body, radiant as a crore of suns: God, always clear my work of obstacles.

Lakshmi, seed mantra

ॐ श्रीं महालक्ष्म्यै नमः

Om Shrim Mahalakshmyai namah.

Salutation to Mahalakshmi. Shrim is a traditional seed-sound used when addressing her. This kit does not add a further meaning for that syllable.

Shri Sukta, verse 1

हिरण्यवर्णां हरिणीं सुवर्णरजतस्रजाम् ।
चन्द्रां हिरण्मयीं लक्ष्मीं जातवेदो म आवह ॥

Hiranyavarnam harinim suvarnarajatasrajam.
Chandram hiranmayim lakshmim jatavedo ma avaha.

O Jatavedas, bring to me Lakshmi, golden in colour, tawny, wearing a garland of gold and silver, moonlike and golden.

Shri Sukta, verse 2

तां म आवह जातवेदो लक्ष्मीमनपगामिनीम् ।
यस्यां हिरण्यं विन्देयं गामश्वं पुरुषानहम् ॥

Tam ma avaha jatavedo lakshmim anapagaminim.
Yasyam hiranyam vindeyam gam ashvam purushan aham.

Bring me, O Jatavedas, that Lakshmi who does not depart, in whom I may find gold, cattle, horses, and people.

Shri Sukta, verse 3

अश्वपूर्वां रथमध्यां हस्तिनादप्रबोधिनीम् ।
श्रियं देवीमुप ह्वये श्रीर्मा देवी जुषताम् ॥

Ashvapurvam rathamadhyam hastinadaprabodhinim.
Shriyam devim upa hvaye shrir ma devi jushatam.

I call the goddess Shri, who comes with horses in front, a chariot in the midst, and is awakened by the elephant's cry. May the goddess Shri be pleased with me.

When you light the lamp

शुभं करोति कल्याणमारोग्यं धनसंपदा ।
शत्रुबुद्धिविनाशाय दीपज्योतिर्नमोऽस्तु ते ॥

Shubham karoti kalyanam arogyam dhanasampada.
Shatrubuddhi-vinashaya dipajyotir namo 'stu te.

Salutation to the lamp's flame, which brings what is auspicious, health, and wealth, and which ends hostile intent.

Lakshmi Gayatri

ॐ महालक्ष्म्यै च विद्महे विष्णुपत्नी च धीमहि ।
तन्नो लक्ष्मीः प्रचोदयात् ॥

Om Mahalakshmyai cha vidmahe Vishnupatni cha dhimahi.
Tanno Lakshmih prachodayat.

We know Mahalakshmi. We meditate on the consort of Vishnu. May that Lakshmi inspire our understanding.

Aarti, opening lines

ॐ जय लक्ष्मी माता, मैया जय लक्ष्मी माता ।
तुमको निशदिन सेवत, हरि विष्णु धाता ॥

Om jai Lakshmi mata, maiya jai Lakshmi mata.
Tumako nishadina sevata, Hari Vishnu dhata.

Victory to Mother Lakshmi. Hari, Vishnu, the sustainer, attends you night and day. The full aarti is longer. Sing the version your family sings.

Checklist

Print this page and tick what you have. Leave a line blank if you are skipping it on purpose.

The corner

☐ A cleaned surface and a cloth

☐ Picture of Lakshmi, and Ganesha if you have one

☐ Jug of water and a coin

☐ Matches or a lighter, only if you will use a flame

The lamp

☐ Ghee or food oil

☐ Cotton wicks, or a tea light

☐ A metal bowl or diya that will not tip

☐ A plate to carry the lamp for aarti

☐ A plan to put the flame out

Offerings

☐ Raw rice

☐ Turmeric or kumkum

☐ Fresh flowers

☐ One fruit

☐ A vegetarian sweet

☐ A notebook, if you keep the account-book custom

People

☐ Housemates told about the flame or the incense

☐ City muhurat written on this page

☐ Temple checked, or a note that you could not reach one

My city: _____ Muhurat I will use: _____

For children

You can read this aloud. It is written for a child who has not grown up in India.

Diwali is the night when families light lamps. In 2026 the main night is Sunday 8 November. The moon is new, so the sky is dark, and the lamps are how the house is lit.

Grown-ups do not all tell the same story. Some say King Rama came home after a long exile, and the city of Ayodhya put out rows of lamps. Some say Lakshmi, who is honoured as the giver of a settled home, visits houses that are clean and bright. Some say Krishna defeated a king named Narakasura, and the morning bath remembers that. Your family may tell one of these. All three are real family stories. None of them cancels the others.

Lakshmi Puja is the part where people sit down, light a lamp, and say thank you. Children can set the flowers, draw on the card at the back of this kit, carry the plate of sweets, and stand next to an adult while the lamp is lit. Children do not light the flame alone.

What you might notice: the house smells like food, someone is on the phone with a grandparent, and a small lamp sits in a corner. That is the festival. You do not have to be quiet the whole time. You do have to leave the flame where an adult can see it.

A line you can say: "We lit a lamp for Diwali." That is a complete sentence. You do not need Sanskrit to be part of it. If you want one short line, the grown-ups' page has "Om Ganeshaya namah" at the start.

CARD 1 · GREETING

Happy Diwali

Sunday 8 November 2026

Wishing you a bright house and a quiet hour for the puja.

ॐ श्रीं महालक्ष्म्यै नमः

From _____

CARD 2 · INVITATION

Please come for Lakshmi Puja

Sunday 8 November 2026

Time _____

Place _____

Host _____

Write the muhurat you confirmed. Do not copy a time from another city.

CARD 3 · DHANTERAS

Happy Dhanteras

Friday 6 November 2026

A small new thing for the house, and a lamp in the evening.

From _____

CARD 4 · BHAI DOOJ

Happy Bhai Dooj

For _____

Our date this year: _____

Drik Panchang lists Tuesday 10 November 2026 in the US, Canada, the UK, and Dubai, and Wednesday 11 November 2026 in New Delhi, Singapore, Australia, and New Zealand. Write the date your temple is keeping.

CARD 5 · A MEAL

Eat with us

Day _____

Time _____

Address _____

We are cooking for Diwali. Tell us if there is food you do not eat.

From _____

CARD 6 · FOR A NEIGHBOUR

This is Diwali

To _____

Diwali is our festival of lamps. The main night in 2026 is Sunday 8 November. You may see a light in our window. You are welcome to say hello.

From _____

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